BUSHLOT SAUNA CLUB

Business Plan

Handcrafted Mobile Saunas | Asheville, North Carolina

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CONFIDENTIAL

TABLE OF CONTENTS

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Bushlot Sauna Club is a start-up artisan manufacturing business based in Asheville, North Carolina, dedicated to designing and building premium, handcrafted mobile saunas. Founded by Stuart King, the company produces four-person saunas constructed on 5x10 utility trailers, enabling customers to transport and use their sauna at any location — from backyards and lakesides to remote campsites.

The sauna market in the United States is experiencing significant growth, driven by rising consumer interest in health, wellness, and intentional living. Bushlot Sauna Club enters this market with a distinct positioning: not merely as a product seller, but as a purveyor of artisan craftsmanship with deep personal heritage. The brand draws on the owner's family story — rooted in a Scandinavian-influenced sauna tradition passed down from his Austrian-born grandfather in northern Ontario — to create an emotional connection that mass-market or kit-based competitors cannot replicate.

The business targets health-conscious, outdoor-oriented consumers in Western North Carolina who believe quality matters and expect honest, transparent value for their investment. Saunas will be sold at a price point of $15,000-$17,000 — all-inclusive of everything a customer needs to sauna from day one — with material costs of approximately $5,500 per unit and total production costs (including contracted labor) of roughly $10,000, yielding a gross margin of approximately 37%-44%. In Year 1, the company aims to complete and sell one to two units as a proof-of-concept phase, establish its brand identity, and lay the groundwork for sustainable growth.

The business will be registered as a single-member LLC in North Carolina, operate out of a family member’s private workshop space in the Asheville area, and be funded through the owner’s personal savings. Stuart King brings a strong analytical and management background — including graduate-level training in international economics, project management consulting, and data science — complemented by his hands-on prototype experience and the craftsmanship support of his family.

Bushlot Sauna Club does not seek outside financing at this stage. The initial phase is focused on proof of concept, product refinement, and brand building. Financial projections show the business reaching break-even within its first year of sales, with profitability scaling as production volume increases in subsequent years.

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

A. Business Concept

Mission Statement

To craft premium, mobile saunas of enduring quality and artistic distinction, inspired by the timeless traditions of sauna culture, and to share the transformative experience of heat, community, and intentional rest with people who believe that how you live matters.

Goals and Objectives

- Year 1: Complete and sell 1-2 prototype-quality mobile saunas; register the LLC; establish brand identity (name, logo, website); obtain necessary insurance and professional engineering review of design plans.
- Year 2: Increase production to 3-5 units; refine the build process and supplier relationships; begin marketing in earnest through an SEO-optimized website and word-of-mouth referrals; explore a small merchandise line (hats, apparel) to build community.
- Year 3: Expand geographic market to eastern Tennessee and northern South Carolina; evaluate adding a fixed installation offering; assess feasibility of contracting labor to scale production; build toward 6-10 units per year.
- Long-Term: Establish Bushlot Sauna Club as the premier artisan mobile sauna brand in the Southeast, recognized for craftsmanship, exclusivity, and cultural authenticity.

Description of Business

Bushlot Sauna Club is a manufacturing business that designs and builds custom, handcrafted mobile saunas. Each sauna is constructed on a 5x10 utility trailer, enabling towing and positioning at any site accessible by road. The four-person sauna cabin is built from premium wood species selected for durability, beauty, and thermal performance.

Customers select from a curated menu of customization options — including sauna stove type, interior wood species, and exterior finish color — keeping the product offering focused and the brand coherent. The limited menu is intentional: Bushlot saunas are not infinitely configurable commodities, but a carefully considered product with a distinct aesthetic. Buyers are purchasing a work of artisan craftsmanship, not merely a functional appliance.

Future offerings include fixed-installation saunas — pre-built units delivered to a permanent site and set on a prepared foundation. Customers may choose to construct the foundation themselves per Bushlot's specifications, or engage Bushlot to construct the foundation as part of the project. A site appraisal will be conducted prior to any fixed installation engagement, and customer-constructed foundations will be reviewed and approved by Bushlot before delivery and installation proceed. The business will also offer branded merchandise such as hats and apparel, envisioned primarily as a community-building tool rather than a major revenue stream.

B. Business Type

Business Type	Manufacturing / Artisan Products
Products	Premium mobile saunas (4-person, trailer-mounted); future fixed installation saunas
Status	Start-up — pre-revenue as of March 2026
Legal Entity	Single-member LLC (registration pending, North Carolina)
Ownership	100% Stuart King

C. Market Served

The primary market is health-conscious, outdoor-oriented adults in Western North Carolina — particularly in the greater Asheville metropolitan area. The initial trade area includes Buncombe, Henderson, Madison, and Haywood counties. As the business grows, the market will expand to include eastern Tennessee (Knoxville, Johnson City, and surrounding areas) and the Upstate South Carolina region, all within practical towing distance.

D. Competitive Advantage

Bushlot Sauna Club's competitive advantage rests on three pillars: heritage, craftsmanship, and mobility. Unlike mass-produced sauna kits available through online retailers, each Bushlot sauna is handcrafted, personally designed, and carries a compelling origin story. The business is not aware of any other company in the Western North Carolina region offering custom-built mobile saunas. This first-mover advantage in a growing, under-served local market — combined with a premium brand identity and personal relationships with early customers — represents a durable differentiator.

DESCRIPTION OF PRODUCTS AND SERVICES

A. Product Features

The flagship product is a four-person barrel- or cabin-style sauna constructed on a 5x10 utility trailer. Key features include:

- Trailer-mounted mobility: The sauna can be towed with a standard pickup truck or SUV, stored in a garage, and positioned at any accessible outdoor location.
- Premium interior wood: Customers select from a curated list of wood species (e.g., premium pine, cedar, or thermally modified wood), each chosen for its thermal properties, aroma, and aesthetic quality.
- Sauna stove selection: Customers choose from a menu of wood-burning or electric sauna stoves, with options at different performance and price tiers.
- Exterior finish: A limited palette of exterior stain or paint colors maintains brand cohesion while allowing meaningful personalization.
- Craftsmanship and detail: Tongue-and-groove joinery, careful sealing, and considered design throughout — built to last and to be admired.
- All-inclusive accessory package: Every sauna is delivered complete and ready to use. The purchase price includes all essential sauna accessories — sauna hats, a traditional bucket and ladle, essential oils, interior lighting, towel hooks, and other items necessary for a full sauna experience. Customers will never be asked to purchase add-ons for things that should come standard.Custom branding: Each sauna will carry a Bushlot Sauna Club maker's mark, reinforcing the artisan identity and supporting brand recognition.

B. Customer Benefits

- Wellness and recovery: Sauna use is associated with a wide range of health benefits, including cardiovascular health, stress reduction, muscle recovery, and improved sleep. Customers invest in their wellbeing.
- Flexibility and freedom: A mobile sauna goes where the customer goes — it is not a permanent fixture requiring permits or site preparation, and can be repositioned or even resold.
- Community and experience: The four-person capacity makes the sauna a social amenity, ideal for family gatherings, friend groups, and wellness-oriented entertaining.
- No surprises, no upsells: Bushlot customers receive everything they need to begin their sauna practice on day one. The all-inclusive purchase model stands in direct contrast to competitors who advertise an attractive base price and then charge separately for accessories that are genuinely necessary to use the product. At Bushlot, what you see is what you get.Artistic ownership: Customers are not buying an appliance. They are acquiring a handcrafted piece of functional art with a story behind it — something they will be proud to own and share.

C. Intellectual Property

At this stage, the business does not hold patents or registered trademarks. The owner will explore trademark registration of the Bushlot Sauna Club name and logo as the brand develops. The sauna design, while not currently patented, benefits from ongoing refinement and the tacit knowledge embedded in the build process. The business intends to obtain professional

engineering review (PE stamp) and CAD renderings of its structural plans, which will formalize the design and potentially enable more consistent production.

D. Production Plans

In Year 1, saunas will be built by the owner with the assistance of family members, using a family member's private workshop space in the Asheville area. The prototype required approximately $5,500 in materials and an estimated 200-300 hours of build time. As the business scales, the owner will transition to contracting production labor to a skilled handyman, reducing the time burden on the owner and enabling simultaneous management and sales activities.

Primary material suppliers currently include Lowe's and Home Depot for standard lumber and hardware. Premium interior wood is sourced from SC Lumber & Supply in Greer, SC. As order volume grows, the business will pursue wholesale supplier relationships to reduce per-unit material costs.

E. Future Products and Services

- Fixed installation saunas: The company will offer a fixed installation service for customers who prefer a permanent sauna at a set location. All fixed-installation saunas are pre-built at the Bushlot workshop and delivered to the customer's site. Prior to engagement, Bushlot will conduct a site appraisal to evaluate site conditions, access, and foundation requirements. Customers may either construct the foundation themselves per Bushlot's provided specifications, or contract Bushlot to build the foundation. In the case of a customer-built foundation, Bushlot will inspect and approve the foundation before proceeding with delivery and installation. This approach ensures consistent product quality and a straightforward installation process regardless of who builds the foundation.
- Branded merchandise: A limited line of hats, t-shirts, and other apparel will be introduced to build community and brand awareness. Merchandise is not expected to be a significant revenue driver.
- Replacement accessories and consumables: While all standard accessories are included with every sauna purchase, the business may in the future offer replacement or upgrade items (additional essential oil blends, premium ladle sets, spare parts) for returning customers. This is envisioned as a convenience offering, not a revenue substitute for what should be included at point of sale.

MARKET PLAN

A. Description of Industry

Background

The sauna industry in the United States has experienced rapid growth in recent years, driven by the broader wellness movement and the mainstream adoption of practices long common in Nordic countries. Infrared saunas, traditional Finnish-style saunas, steam rooms, and cold-water plunge pools have become increasingly prevalent in gyms, spas, wellness centers, and private residences. The COVID-19 pandemic accelerated home wellness investment, with many consumers seeking health-supporting amenities that could be enjoyed privately.

The residential sauna market, in particular, has grown substantially, fueled by growing consumer awareness of the health benefits of regular sauna use — supported by a growing body of clinical research — and increased media coverage of sauna culture from Scandinavia and beyond.

Current and Future Trends

- Growing consumer interest in heat therapy, cold plunge, and recovery-focused wellness practices.
- Expansion of communal sauna offerings in urban markets — evidenced locally by venues such as Sauna House and Drip Sauna in Asheville, NC.
- Increasing demand for outdoor and backyard wellness amenities, particularly among homeowners who invested in outdoor living during and after the pandemic.
- Rising interest in mobile and modular structures, particularly among RV and van life communities, outdoor enthusiasts, and property owners in rural or semi-rural settings.
- Growing market for artisan and locally made goods, with consumers actively seeking alternatives to mass-produced products.

Business Fit in the Industry

Bushlot Sauna Club occupies a distinctive niche: the intersection of the wellness product market and the artisan craftsmanship market. The business is not positioned as a high-volume, low-cost producer, but rather as a premium maker of bespoke mobile saunas with a strong regional identity and personal brand story. This positioning is well-aligned with the cultural character of the Asheville market, which has a strong tradition of supporting local artisans, wellness businesses, and outdoor recreation.

B. Your Market

Customer Profile and Target Market

The target customer is a health-conscious, outdoor-oriented adult, typically between 30 and 60 years of age, with above-average disposable income and a strong preference for quality over price. This customer:

- Values wellness practices and is willing to invest meaningfully in them.
- Has an appreciation for craftsmanship, design, and authenticity.

- Spends time outdoors — hiking, camping, or on rural property.
- Is likely familiar with sauna culture through travel, wellness communities, or local venues.
- Lives in or near Western North Carolina, or is connected to the region through vacation property or family.

Secondary customers include Airbnb and short-term rental property owners looking to differentiate their listings with a premium amenity, as well as wellness retreat operators and small businesses.

Trade Area

The primary trade area is Western North Carolina, with emphasis on the Asheville metro area (Buncombe, Henderson, Haywood, and Madison counties). The mobile nature of the product — saunas are trailer-mounted — means delivery and installation are feasible across a wider geography without a significant logistical barrier. Secondary markets include eastern Tennessee (Knoxville metro and surrounding areas) and the Upstate South Carolina region (Greenville-Spartanburg), all within roughly 2-3 hours of Asheville.

Market Size and Potential

The Asheville metropolitan area has a population of approximately 500,000, with a strong concentration of the target demographic — educated, health-conscious professionals and outdoor recreationists. The region's robust tourism industry and high concentration of short-term rental properties represent an additional demand driver. While precise market size data for mobile saunas specifically is not available, the broader residential sauna market in the US was valued at over $700 million in 2023 and is projected to grow at a compound annual rate exceeding 5% through 2030. The mobile/portable segment, though smaller, is among the fastest-growing categories.

Market Trends

Key trends supporting market potential include: the mainstreaming of sauna use among American consumers; the success of local communal sauna businesses (indicating strong local demand); the growth of the outdoor recreation and overlanding communities, who represent natural early adopters of a mobile sauna; and the premium placed on locally made, artisan goods in the Asheville market.

C. Competition

Direct Competition

Direct competitors are businesses offering comparable sauna products at comparable price points. Key examples include:

- Almost Heaven Saunas (Renick, WV): A well-established manufacturer of barrel and cabin saunas, selling directly to consumers online. Offers pre-built and kit options at a range of price points. Highly visible online presence.
- Dundalk LeisureCraft (Ontario, Canada): A major North American producer of cedar saunas, widely distributed online and through retail partners. Strong brand recognition, broad product line.

- Saunacore, SaunaSpace, and other online direct-to-consumer brands: A growing number of e-commerce sauna brands target the residential market with ready-to-assemble and pre-built options.

None of the above competitors are known to operate a local or regional presence in Western North Carolina, and none offer a custom, mobile, trailer-mounted sauna product with the artisan positioning of Bushlot Sauna Club.

Indirect Competition

Indirect competition includes DIY sauna kit manufacturers (whose customers may choose to self-build rather than purchase), communal sauna memberships (Sauna House, Drip Sauna), and other outdoor wellness products (hot tubs, cold plunge tubs) that compete for the same wellness budget.

Competitive Advantage

Bushlot Sauna Club's competitive advantages are meaningful and defensible:

- Local, artisan identity: No known local competitor builds custom mobile saunas in Western North Carolina. The business benefits from the strong local-first purchasing culture in the Asheville market.
- Mobility and flexibility: Unlike most competitor products, Bushlot saunas are fully mobile and can be repositioned or transported by the owner — a genuine functional differentiator.
- Brand story and authenticity: The owner's personal heritage — a grandfather who immigrated from Austria to Canada, learned sauna traditions from his Scandinavian neighbors, and built his own sauna, which became a defining part of Stuart's childhood summers — is a compelling and authentic narrative that mass-market brands cannot replicate.
- Customization within constraint: The curated customization menu gives buyers meaningful personal choice while maintaining product coherence and brand identity.
- Premium quality at an honest price: The use of high-grade materials and careful craftsmanship produces a product visibly superior to mass-produced alternatives — delivered at a price that is competitive, transparent, and all-inclusive. Customers receive exceptional value without being surprised by add-on costs after the sale.

D. Market Strategies

Market Positioning

Bushlot Sauna Club is positioned as a premium artisan brand that believes high quality and honest affordability are not mutually exclusive. The brand competes on craftsmanship, story, and value — delivering a superior product at a price that respects the customer’s investment without hidden costs or unnecessary upsells. Marketing language and visual identity will emphasize heritage, warmth, quality, and transparency. The limited number of units produced per year reinforces intentionality and craftsmanship — each sauna is a considered acquisition, not an impulse purchase, and every customer receives a complete, ready-to-use product from day one.

Pricing

Mobile saunas will be priced at $15,000-$17,000. This is an all-inclusive price: every sauna is delivered with everything a customer needs to begin using it immediately — including sauna hats, a bucket and ladle, essential oils, interior lighting, towel hooks, and other standard accessories. This approach reflects a core brand value: customers should not have to pay extra for items that are genuinely necessary to enjoy the product. Many competitors sell saunas at an attractive headline price only to charge separately for accessories that should be standard. Bushlot does not operate that way.The pricing reflects premium materials and handcrafted quality while remaining genuinely accessible to the target demographic. Fixed-installation saunas will be priced comparably for the pre-built sauna unit (also all-inclusive of accessories), with site appraisal, delivery, and installation quoted separately based on site conditions. Where Bushlot constructs the foundation, that cost will be scoped and quoted as an additional line item. Pricing will be revisited annually as production costs, market response, and brand equity evolve.

Promotion and Advertising

- Website: A professionally designed, SEO website will serve as the primary marketing and sales asset. The site will feature high-quality photography of completed saunas, the brand story, product specifications, and a contact or inquiry form. SEO content will target searches such as 'custom sauna Asheville,' 'mobile sauna North Carolina,' and 'artisan sauna for sale.'
- Word of mouth and referrals: Early customers in a market like Asheville are likely to be well-connected. Encouraging customers to share their Bushlot sauna — through social gatherings, on social media, or in online communities — will be a primary organic growth driver.
- Social media: While not the primary marketing channel, Instagram in particular is a natural fit for showcasing the visual quality of the product. The owner will maintain an authentic presence highlighting the build process, the sauna experience, and the brand story.
- Local presence: Opportunities to be present at local wellness events, outdoor recreation gatherings, or artisan markets in the Asheville area will be evaluated. Displaying or demonstrating the product at a public event could generate significant awareness.
- PR and editorial coverage: The unique story of a mobile, handcrafted sauna business rooted in family heritage is a natural candidate for local media coverage (Asheville Citizen-Times, Mountain Xpress) and regional lifestyle publications. Press outreach will be explored.

Distribution

Sales will be direct-to-consumer. Customers will inquire through the website or by referral, engage with the owner directly to discuss customization options and logistics, and take delivery of their sauna by pickup or owner delivery within the regional trade area. No retail or wholesale distribution channel is planned at this stage.

Customer Service

Given the premium price point and artisan positioning, customer service is a critical brand element. The owner will personally manage all customer communication throughout the design, build, and delivery process. A warranty policy will be developed prior to first sale, covering materials and workmanship for a minimum period. Post-delivery follow-up will be standard

practice, and customer satisfaction will be actively solicited to inform product and service improvements.

MANAGEMENT STRUCTURE AND ORGANIZATION

A. Legal Form of Ownership

Bushlot Sauna Club will be registered as a single-member Limited Liability Company (LLC) in the State of North Carolina. LLC registration is pending as of the date of this plan. The LLC structure provides personal liability protection for the owner, a flexible tax treatment (pass-through taxation), and a professional legal identity for the business without the complexity of a corporation.

B. Management and Personnel

Owner Background and Qualifications

Stuart King is the sole owner and operator of Bushlot Sauna Club. He brings an unusually strong combination of analytical, managerial, and creative skills to the venture:

- Education: Bachelor's degree in Business Management; Master's degree in International Economics.
- Project management and consulting: Significant professional experience as a project management consultant for international development programs, involving complex multi-stakeholder projects, budget management, reporting, and cross-cultural communication.
- Data science: Subsequent career as a data scientist at a financial payments processor and a home insurance company, developing expertise in quantitative analysis, process optimization, and decision-making under uncertainty.
- Hands-on product development: Designed and built the Bushlot prototype sauna independently, gaining direct experience in materials selection, construction techniques, and product design — demonstrating technical capability alongside business acumen.

Stuart's diverse background is particularly well-suited to the demands of a start-up business: he can manage finances, analyze market data, handle project logistics, engage with customers, and execute on the product itself. His data science background, in particular, provides a rigorous framework for business planning, financial modeling, and performance evaluation.

Additional Personnel

In the initial phase, production will be supported by the owner's father, who will assist with sauna construction. As volume increases in Year 2 and beyond, the owner plans to contract build labor to a skilled handyman with the relevant construction experience. This arrangement provides flexibility and cost control without the commitment of a full-time employee. Future hiring decisions will be evaluated as production volume warrants.

C. Organizational Structure

As a sole proprietorship operating as a single-member LLC, all management functions — sales, production, finance, marketing, and customer service — are currently handled by the owner. The organizational structure is intentionally flat and lean, consistent with a proof-of-concept phase operation. An advisory relationship with a CPA will be established to support accounting

and tax preparation. The owner will also engage a structural engineer (PE) to review and formally certify the sauna design plans.

D. Additional Resources and Advisors

- A-B Tech Small Business Center (SBC): The owner is engaged with the A-B Tech SBC for business planning support and guidance.
- Structural Engineer (PE): To be engaged for review and certification of sauna structural plans prior to first commercial sale.
- CAD Professional: To be engaged for professional technical drawings of the sauna design.
- CPA / Bookkeeper: To be engaged for LLC setup, tax planning, and ongoing accounting.
- Attorney: To be engaged as needed for LLC formation, any contract templates (sales agreements, warranty documents), and general legal counsel.

BUSINESS OPERATIONS

A. Business Location

The business mailing address is 9 Pruitt Street, Asheville, NC 28806. Production operations will be conducted at a family member's private workshop space in the greater Asheville area, which offers adequate square footage and infrastructure for trailer-mounted sauna builds.

The workshop location provides practical road access for towing finished saunas and is in proximity to Asheville. There is no plan to open a retail or customer-facing location in the near term; all customer interactions will be conducted remotely or on-site at the customer's location.

B. Licenses and Permits

LLC Registration	North Carolina Secretary of State — pending
Business Name (DBA)	To be confirmed — Bushlot Sauna Club
Federal EIN	To be obtained upon LLC formation
NC Sales & Use Tax	Registration with NC Dept. of Revenue required
Workshop Lease	Private arrangement with family member — greater Asheville area
Zoning	Private workshop space — zoning and permitting requirements to be confirmed
Business Insurance	General liability and product liability coverage — to be obtained
PE Stamp	Structural engineering review and certification of sauna design plans — to be obtained
Trailer Registration	Each sauna trailer will be registered as a vehicle in NC

The business does not anticipate requiring a general contractor license for its mobile sauna product, as units are pre-built off-site and sold as personal property. Fixed-installation offerings — which also involve pre-built units delivered to and set on a customer's site — may require evaluation of applicable building permit requirements depending on county regulations and site classification. Where Bushlot constructs the customer's foundation, additional contractor licensing considerations may apply and will be evaluated with legal counsel prior to offering that service commercially. Legal counsel will be engaged as needed throughout this process.

FINANCIAL PLAN

A. Start-Up Investment Requirements

Start-Up Costs

The following table summarizes estimated one-time start-up costs required to launch Bushlot Sauna Club commercially:

Start-Up Item	Estimated Cost	Notes
LLC Registration (NC)	$125	NC Secretary of State filing fee
Operating Agreement / Legal	$300 - $500	Attorney or online service
Business Insurance (Year 1)	$1,000 - $1,500	General & product liability
PE Structural Review	$1,500 - $2,000	Engineering stamp on design plans
CAD Renderings	$1,000 - $1,500	Professional technical drawings
Website Design & Launch	$500 - $1,000	Domain, hosting, design
Initial Marketing (photography, materials)	$500 - $1,000	Professional product photography
Materials — First Commercial Unit	$5,500	Based on prototype costs
Miscellaneous / Contingency	$500	Unexpected start-up expenses
TOTAL	$10,925 - $13,525	

Note: The owner's prototype (already completed) is not included in the above start-up costs, as its cost was borne prior to formal business launch. The owner's personal investment in the prototype represents meaningful equity in the form of proof-of-concept validation and production know-how.

Source and Application of Funds

Source of Funds	Personal savings — 100% self-funded
Estimated Available Capital	Up to approximately $15,000
Funding Gap (if applicable)	If a modest gap exists between available capital and total start-up costs the owner will prioritize essential expenditures (LLC, insurance, first unit materials) and phase in non-critical costs (CAD renderings, photography) as first-unit revenue is received.
Financing Sought	None at this time

B. Financial Projections

Assumptions

- Average selling price per unit: $16,000 (midpoint of $15,000-$17,000 range).
- Average variable cost per unit: $5,500 (materials) — assumes owner performs or supervises labor; contracted labor adds approximately $4,500-$5,000/unit.
- Year 1 production: 1 unit; Year 2: 3 units; Year 3: 6 units.
- Labor costs are included in COGS beginning in Year 2, when contracted labor is anticipated.
- Fixed operating expenses include insurance, website hosting, and minor marketing spend.
- Tax and depreciation not modeled in this early-stage projection; to be addressed with CPA.

Projected Income Statement

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Units Sold	1	3	6
Revenue	$16,000	$48,000	$96,000
Cost of Goods Sold (Materials)	$5,500	$16,500	$33,000
Labor (contracted)	$0	$13,500	$27,000
Gross Profit	$10,500	$18,000	$36,000
Gross Margin %	65.6%	37.5%	37.5%
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Insurance	$1,200	$1,200	$1,400
Website & Hosting	$800	$600	$600
Marketing & Advertising	$500	$1,500	$2,500
Legal / Professional Fees	$1,000	$500	$500
PE Review / CAD (one-time)	$3,500	$0	$0
Miscellaneous	$300	$500	$800
Total Operating Expenses	$7,300	$4,300	$5,800
Net Operating Income	$3,200	$13,700	$30,200

Note: Year 1 operating expenses are higher due to one-time start-up costs (PE review, CAD renderings, legal fees for LLC setup). Year 2 and beyond reflect the normalized cost structure.

Break-Even Analysis

The break-even point is the level of revenue at which total costs equal total revenue — i.e., the point at which the business neither profits nor loses money.

Metric	Value
Average Selling Price / Unit	$16,000
Variable Cost / Unit (materials only, self-build)	$5,500
Variable Cost / Unit (materials + contracted labor)	$10,000
Contribution Margin (self-build)	$10,500
Contribution Margin (with contracted labor)	$6,000
Annual Fixed Costs (Year 2 onward)	~$4,300
Break-Even Units (self-build)	0.41 units/year (< 1 sale)
Break-Even Units (contracted labor)	0.72 units/year (< 1 sale)

The break-even analysis is favorable: under either production scenario, the sale of a single unit covers all annual fixed operating costs with significant margin remaining. In Year 1, the higher one-time start-up expenses raise the effective break-even threshold, but the single planned sale is projected to yield positive net income after all start-up costs are accounted for.

Cash Flow Summary

Cash flow management is critical for a business producing high-value, made-to-order goods with a production cycle of several weeks. The owner will explore requiring a deposit (e.g., 25-50% of purchase price) at the time of order, with the balance due upon delivery. This structure helps offset material costs during the build period and reduces cash flow risk.

With a lean cost structure and self-funded operations, the business is not expected to face significant cash flow challenges in Year 1, provided that one sale is completed. Cash flow projections will be developed in greater detail (monthly, for the first year) prior to launch, in consultation with the business's CPA.

CONCLUSION

A. Statement of Feasibility

Bushlot Sauna Club is a financially viable and strategically sound business concept. The market for premium residential saunas is growing, the local Asheville market is particularly well-suited to an artisan wellness product, and no direct local competitor currently occupies this niche. The owner brings a compelling combination of business acumen, analytical capability, and personal passion for the product. The financial projections show a path to profitability within the first year of sales, with meaningful income growth as production scales in Years 2 and 3.

The primary risks are the limited initial capital, the owner's reliance on personal labor for early production, and the long sales cycle inherent in high-value custom products. These risks are manageable and are mitigated by the lean cost structure, the phased growth plan, and the strength of the brand positioning. The proof-of-concept approach in Year 1 — completing and selling one to two units — is a prudent and realistic way to validate the market before committing to more significant investment.

B. Action Plan

Action Item	Target Timeline	Owner / Resource
Register LLC with NC Secretary of State	April 2026	Owner / Attorney
Obtain EIN from IRS	April 2026	Owner
Open dedicated business bank account	April 2026	Owner
Obtain general and product liability insurance	April 2026	Insurance broker
Confirm workshop space arrangement with family member	April 2026	Owner
Engage PE for structural review of sauna plans	May 2026	Owner / PE
Commission professional CAD renderings	May 2026	Owner / CAD professional
Launch website (domain, hosting, initial content)	May-June 2026	Owner
Begin production of first commercial unit	May 2026	Owner + family
Complete and deliver first unit; collect first revenue	Q3 2026	Owner

Evaluate contracted labor for second unit	Q3 2026	Owner
Develop warranty policy and sales agreement template	Before first sale	Owner / Attorney
Register for NC Sales & Use Tax	Before first sale	Owner / CPA
Develop Year 2 production and marketing plan	Q4 2026	Owner

C. Supporting Documents

The following documents will be assembled as supporting materials for this business plan:

- Prototype cost summary and materials list
- Professional CAD renderings of sauna design (upon completion)
- PE structural review certification (upon completion)
- Workshop space arrangement confirmation (upon finalization)
- NC LLC Certificate of Organization (upon filing)
- Business insurance certificate (upon issuance)
- Owner resume / professional background summary
- Website URL (upon launch)